

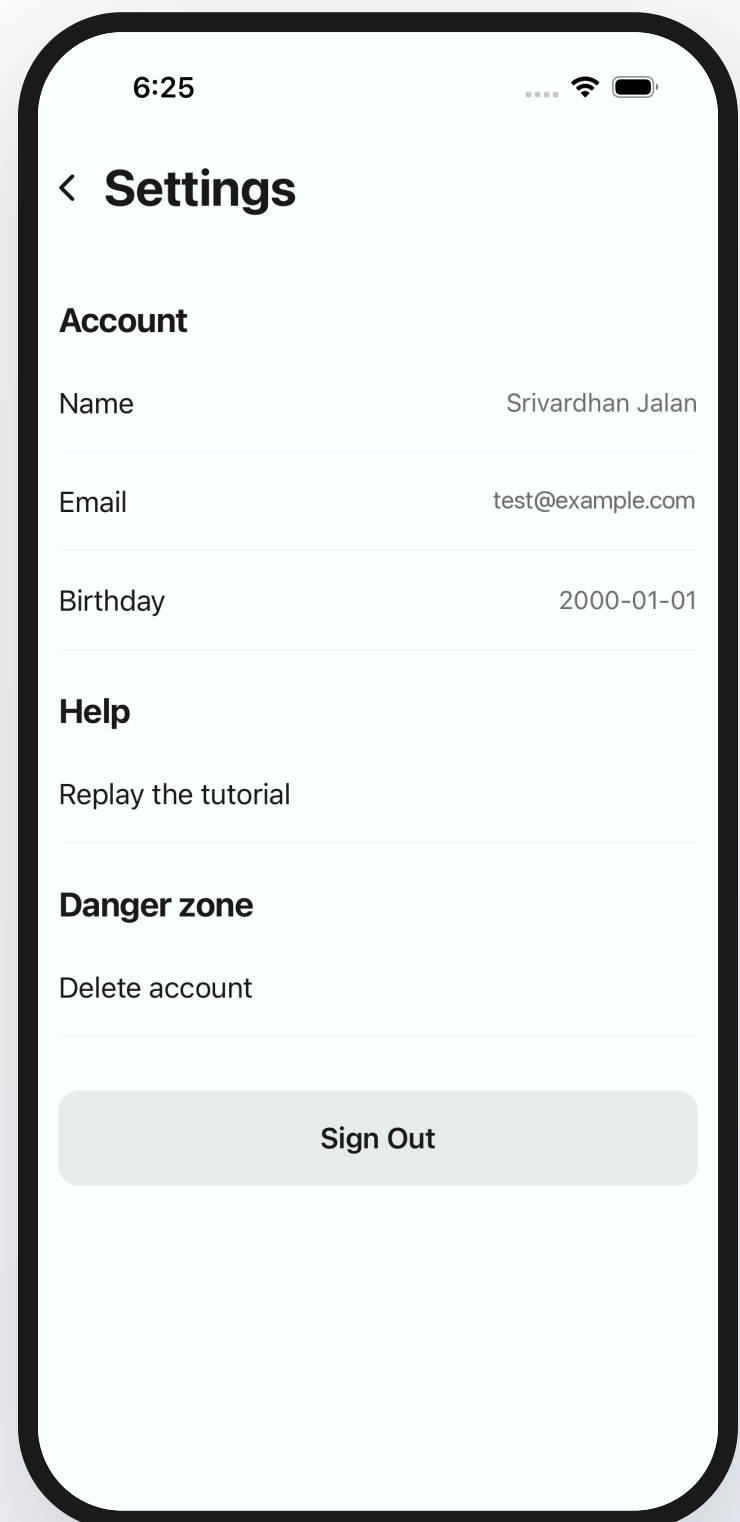
Handle with care.

A Settings screen that edits you in two places at once — and deletes you for good — the part most apps get wrong.

SWIPE →

Handle With Care.

@SRIVARDHANJALAN



WHAT THE STEP SHIPPED

One screen, two hard problems.

The Settings screen — change your name, set your birthday, delete your account — took an afternoon. The real work was underneath: keeping your name in sync, and deleting you so you're **actually** gone.

THE BUG I INHERITED

Write to every store that **reads**.

The obvious way to save a name is to write it to Clerk. But the backend keeps its own copy — written once at sign-in, create-only. Write to Clerk alone and it goes stale, with nothing to heal it.

```
// Clerk greets you; the backend record is the  
copy later steps read  
await user?.update({ firstName, lastName });  
await updateProfile({ first_name, last_name });
```

A fact kept in two places, edited in one, is a bug with a delay on it.

PADDING IS DATA

The wheels came up blank.

The birthday is three picker wheels. Values were unpadded ("1"), labels padded ("01") — so a stored "01" matched no wheel value. The fix strips padding on load, re-pads on save.

6:25

< Settings

Account

Name Srivardhan Jalan

Email test@example.com

2002
2001
2000
1999
1998

01 01 2000
02 02
03 03

Save Birthday

Cancel

Help

Replay the tutorial

Danger zone

HANDLE WITH CARE

4 / 8

DELETING YOU PROPERLY

Three decisions, each easy to botch.

→ Keep the record, just flag it — later steps point at it.

→ Delete from Clerk first, then flag — so whichever write fails, the leftover state is the harmless one.

→ Guard the write at the database, not in app memory — a cached instance could keep writing after you're gone.

THE GUARD

At the table, not in **memory**.

The flag write itself is unconditional. Every **mutating** endpoint carries a condition
DynamoDB re-checks — the record must exist
and not be flagged deleted. A token minted
seconds before deletion bounces.

```
ACTIVE = "attribute_exists(id) AND  
(attribute_not_exists(is_deleted) OR is_deleted =  
:active)"  
users.update_item(Key=...,  
ConditionExpression=ACTIVE) # 403 on a dead token
```

THE PAYOFF

"Couldn't find your account."



05-profiles – delete for good

```
# typed DELETE in the app, confirmed →  
$ aws dynamodb get-item --table-name kivan-...  
  "first_name": "Srivardhan", "is_deleted": true  
$ # sign back in with the same password →  
  Couldn't find your account.
```

I typed DELETE into my own app, confirmed, it threw me out — signed back in with the same password and got four words back.

ZERO TO SHIPPED · STEP 05

The full write-up is free.

The write-up has the how — the dual-write, the failure-ordering, and the table guard that bounces a just-deleted token.

Link in the comments ↓

★ the repo to follow along

`github.com/srivardhanjalan/kivan-tutorial`